Green River College

Aviation Technology

1221 D St NE Auburn, WA 98002

www.greenriver.edu/aviation T: 253-931-6580

- Follow us on Facebook at Green River College Aviation or
- Instagram at grcaviation or
- LinkedIn at Green River College Aviation Technology

,

Gator Grad

A chance encounter at Auburn Center allowed Program Coordinator Tami Kapule the opportunity to meet Bryan Zandi. He is a recent graduate who happened to be on campus meeting with faculty. We are so excited to share his good news as our current Gator Grad spotlight.

"My name is Bryan Zandi. I was born in 1982 in Iran when the devastating war between Iran and Iraq, which lasted eight years, had just begun. Ironically, growing up through the war and witnessing fighter jets flying overhead every day prompted my interest in aviation, and I dreamed of becoming a pilot. However, as a religious and political minority in my own country, I never had the opportunity to pursue my dream due to the intricate socio-political environment of the state. Therefore, I decided to veer my path and schooled in an entirely different course, hospitality. Even though I obtained a master's degree in Hotel and Tourism Management and worked as a professional in hospitality for the next decade, I never stopped dreaming of becoming a pilot.

Upcoming Events

Saturday/Sunday Feb. 24/25
We hope to see you at the **40th Annual** Northwest Conference and Trade Show!
Hosted at the Washington State Fairgrounds:
Saturday 9AM – 530PM; Sunday 10AM – 4PM.

Friday March 22nd
Winter quarter ends

In This Edition

Gator Grad
Introducing Aviation Alumni Bryan Zandi

Special Interest Section
Welcome aboard Snohomish Flying Service, our newest partner flight school

Aviation Technology Staff
Introducing James Mitchell, our most recent flight simulator technician

In 2012, I was granted a US visa and immigrated to the land of opportunity with my wife and 3-year-old son. Initially, I intended to continue my education and get my Ph.D. in hospitality management. However, after communicating with various colleges and universities, I realized the objective was somewhat unachievable. Although most academic institutes validated my master's degree in hotel and tourism management after evaluation, they equated it to an associate degree in the US. They suggested I study for a couple more years to obtain a grade equivalent to the US academic degree.

I then decided to pursue a degree and career in aviation instead of redoing hospitality management from the beginning. On a late summer day in 2014, I walked into the office of the aviation department manager of Green River College and discussed my objective of becoming a pilot. He took the time to explain all the criteria to me and assisted me with enrolling in the Aviation program at Green River College. A few weeks later, I commenced my education in aviation by attending the first class of the course, Aviation 101! The college staff also helped me find a good flight school, and a few weeks later, I conducted my first-ever flight lesson on a Cessna 172 out of Crest Airpark (S36) in Covington, WA. It was an unforgettable day!

I worked two jobs, one full-time and one part-time, to provide for my wife, son, our newborn baby and cover the flight school costs. I attended college classes from 7 am to 1 pm, worked at a grocery store from 1:30 to 3:30 pm as freight crew (stacking shelves), rested for 6 hours, and worked a graveyard shift as a hotel security officer, which allowed me to do my school assignments during my downtime. Four challenging but outstanding and unique years passed, and in June 2018, I graduated from Green River College's Aviation program with a bachelor's degree in Aeronautical Science. I continued my flight training at Crest Airpark, and after successfully completing the Private Pilot training and adding Instrument rating, I passed my Commercial Pilot check ride on a breezy fall day and officially became a commercial pilot. However, with only 300 hours of flight time, I was far from getting an airline job. Thus, I decided to obtain the multi-engine airplane add-on and a flight instructor license in order to work as a CFI and build more flight time.

By the start of the COVID-19 pandemic, my plans came to a halt since almost no flight school accepted flight applicants. A year flew by, and I found a flight school in Bellefontaine, Ohio, where I put myself through Certified Flight Instructor (CFI) and Multi-Engine Instructor (MEI) courses. During all these years, I worked hard at my workplaces and had multiple promotions. After working as a security officer, I was promoted to Security Supervisor and then to Security Manager. Almost a year later, I transitioned to a Site Operations Manager position overseeing the parking and valet operations of one of downtown Seattle's largest and most fabulous hotels.

Upon successfully completing the CFI & MEI courses, which transpired almost simultaneously after graduating from the Embry-Riddle Aeronautical University and obtaining my master's in business

administration in Aviation (MBAA), I quit the hospitality field and began working as an aviation professional. I taught flying to aviation enthusiasts and new pilots out of the Renton Municipal Airport and Crest Airpark, where I learned how to fly myself.

In mid-2023, when I met the airline pilot requirements, I applied to Republic Airways' First Officer position. I selected this airline because of its outstanding safety records, excellent customer service reputation, and exceptional corporate culture. After a few interviews and completion of the Airline Transport Pilot (ATP) course at FlightSafety International in Dallas, TX, I was offered a First Officer job by the airline and began my training in late summer in Carmel, IN.

I graduated from the training and passed my ATP check ride with an Embraer 170-190 Type-Rating in November 2023. As an Indianapolis-based airline pilot who transports passengers all over the Mid-West and the East Coast, I can tell the years of hard work paid off, and I made my piloting dream come true! My goal for the next five years is to gain more experience in the Part-121 world, transition to a legacy air career, most likely Delta Airlines which is based in my hometown of Seattle, and eventually upgrade to the captain position.

This journey taught me that the road to success passes through transparent dreams, thorough planning, and proper actions. I want to finish this narrative with a precious quote from my favorite actor, Denzel Washington:

"Dreams without goals are just dreams, and they ultimately fuel disappointment! On the road to achieving your dreams, you must apply discipline, but more importantly, consistency. Because without commitment, you will never start, but without consistency, you never finish!""

Bryan you are such an inspiration. Way to model the power of what's possible when you put your heart and soul into making your dreams come true. We wish you the best with your well-earned career; so proud of you!

Calling all students!!

If you would like to see your aviation journey highlighted in our *Student Spotlight* section, please contact Tami Kapule at **TKAPULE@GREENRIVER.EDU.**
We partner with General Aviation News, and they may pick up some of our stories in their 2024 publications!

Special Interest Section

Last month we did a soft announcement of our most recent partnership with a new flight school, Snohomish Flying Service. Thanks to the contribution from Vice President and General Manager Preston Harvey, we are so excited to share more of their story, and the family's legacy to the community.

"SNOHOMISH FLYING SERVICE (SFS) is located in the beautiful Snohomish River Valley, surrounded by breathtaking views of the Cascade and Olympic Mountain Ranges, and situated on the 150-acre privately owned, Snohomish Regional - Harvey Field Airport. As an FAA Designated General Aviation (GA) Reliever Airport in the Puget Sound Region, Harvey Field boasts a solid and committed 80-year history to the aviation community, with more than 200 based aircraft, and over 100,000 flight operations, annually.

The airport is served by two airstrips, a 2,750' asphalt runway and a parallel 2,665' turf runway. It is conveniently located within walking distance of historic downtown Snohomish; a charming destination offering a variety of antique and specialty shops, restaurants, and galleries, as well as a paved river walk trail throughout the scenic shopping area.

Snohomish Regional – Harvey Field Airport (S43)
The modern-day Harvey Field resides on a portion of the John Harvey Family Homestead, settled in 1859. With a substantial legacy of community involvement, the original John and Christina Harvey homestead proudly remains in family ownership today; 165 years later and six generations strong.

Past Events

Port Jobs Pilot Training Session

On Thursday, January 18th Aviation Technology faculty and staff presented another pilot training information session at SeaTac Airport in collaboration with Port Jobs. Additionally, there were preliminary discussions regarding GRC faculty teaching classes for Port Jobs Airport University in 2024!

Advising Day Winter 2024

Aviation Technology hosted another highly successful Advising Day on Tuesday January 30th. Faculty served approximately 50 students, both in-person and via Zoom.

This homestead land was destined to become an airport from early on. The first balloon flight occurred in 1908, followed by the first airplane flight on May 7, 1911, in which famed barnstormer Fred J. Wiseman brought his biplane to Snohomish for an exhibition.

First Balloon Flight (1908) & First Airplane Flight (1911)

Airport Construction began in 1944 by Noble and Eldon Harvey, with the help of family friend, Wesley Loback. Hangars were added by 1947, along with a restaurant and flight school; shop buildings for aircraft maintenance and an office building for administration and airport operations quickly followed. Skydiving launched at Harvey Field in 1961 with Seattle Skydivers, the oldest skydiving club in the U.S. The current operation today, Skydive Snohomish, is owned and operated by the Harvey family.

Early Airport and Flight Training Days

SNOHOMISH FLYING SERVICE is a full service FBO, incorporated in 1950, offering FAA approved, single and multi-engine flight training programs, ranging from the initial Private Pilot to the career bound Professional Commercial Pilot. Our staff of highly skilled flight instructors and administrative professionals make it our mission to encourage and support every student throughout their aviation journey. We prioritize the educating, training, and graduating of superior, well-trained, and qualified pilots. The goal of SFS is to provide flight training that is accessible, affordable, enjoyable, and safe. SFS has teamed with Meritize Lending and Pilot Finance to offer student financing options. Our school is approved by the Department of Veteran's Affairs to train military veterans, and we participate in advanced career development programs with local companies, such as Boeing. Scholarship opportunities are also available.

SFS offers many serviced-based, on-site amenities such as, an Aviation Medical Examiner, FAA written testing facility, flight simulators, automated accounting & flight training scheduling, as well as free Wi-Fi. Furnished, on-campus dorm accommodations, with convenient laundry facilities, are available for full-time college and international students. Monthly safety seminars are held in the SFS conference room, including FAAST and WPA presentations, both of which count towards FAAST Wings credit.

The school's fleet of planes include single engine aircraft Piper J-3 Cub, Aeronca Champ, Evektor SportStar, Evektor Harmony, Cessna 152s, 172Ns, 172Ss, 172S G1000s, 182P, Cessna 182RG Skylane,

the twin-engine Beechcraft Duchess 76, and a Cessna 185 Skywagon on Amphibs. In addition, we operate two Precision Flight Control AATDs, Analog and G1000.

SNOHOMISH FLYING SERVICE has proudly operated under the same ownership since inception, training exceptional pilots for 74 years and counting. We value our relationships with institutions of higher learning and are thrilled to welcome a partnership with Green River College in our students' pursuit of the Restricted Airline Transport Pilot Program.

Visit us on Facebook, check out our website https://www.snohomishflying.com/, contact us by email PilotTraining@SnohomishFlying.com or talk to one of our friendly enrollment staff by calling (360) 568-1541 ext. 223. We look forward to the opportunity of becoming part of your aviation journey.

SNOHOMISH
FLYING SERVICE

Blue Skies!

Aviation Technology Staff

We are so pleased to introduce you to our newest flight simulator technician who is joining the ranks for the 2024 school year. James Mitchell joined our team in January and began scheduling training sessions with our flight simulator students. Here is his story:

"Hello everyone! I'm James Mitchell and I am a new Simulator Instructor here at Green River College. I'm a Commercial Multi-engine Pilot and a Certified Flight Instructor-Instrument with 1700 flight hours. I will be an instructor here until I start my career with Republic Airways as a First Officer flying the Embraer 175.

I am not a Washington native and have only lived here a short two years. I grew up in Rancho Cucamonga, California. I graduated from high school and enlisted in the U.S. Air Force as a Security Forces Member. My first duty station was relatively close to home. I called Edwards Air Force Base in the Mojave Desert of California, "home" for the majority of my enlistment. While I was at Edwards AFB, I met my beautiful wife there at the base gym and in 2016 we got married. I closed out my 10-year military career being stationed at Minot AFB, North Dakota. I also earned my bachelors in criminal justice, as I originally wanted to be an Agent with the FBI.

The military gave me a lot of opportunities to do and see many amazing things. Here is a quick snapshot of my military career: deployed to Afghanistan in 2010, deployed to Abdullah Al-Mubarak Air Base, Kuwait and Kobani Syria in 2017, endured -50-degree temperatures in Minot, ND. I've jumped out of planes, ate bugs, slept in all conditions and sacrificed blood, sweat and tears for the U.S. Air Force and I would do it all again.

My wife is still serving in the military as a Commissioned Officer assigned to King County International/Boeing Field with the Defense Contract Management Agency. Before we came to Washington, we lived in Anchorage, Alaska where we fully explored the beautiful landscape of the last frontier, salmon fished, ran from bears and moose, and found a love and passion for flying. That drove a major career switch! Specifically, at Merrill Field in Anchorage, I started my journey learning to fly. Flying has overall come pretty natural to me, and I have made it my goal to show and teach how fun, easy, and rewarding flying, can be…. but most of all, how unforgiving it can be if you become a complacent aviator.

When I'm not flying or talking about flying, you can find me running, lifting weights, enjoying the outdoors, and playing or listening to music. My absolute favorite activity is being silly with my two little boys and my wife. We won't be in Washington for much longer, due to military obligations, but we are making the best memories here.

If you see me walking around campus, please come say 'hi', I'll be that tall guy walking around with collared shirt on. I'm excited to make an impact here at Green River College."

Welcome aboard James, we are so excited to have you here with us and look forward to the positive influence you will have on our students!

Our services

Green River designed its Aviation Technology program to provide students with a real-world education and competitive advantages in the job market. Advanced technology, exceptional instructors, and specialized Federal Aviation Administration-approved programs prepare students of every experience level with a foundation in aviation weather, air transportation, air traffic control, English and Math.

Equipment

Redbird Motion Simulator

Log training and classroom hours in this full-motion flight simulator. Five wraparound screens combine with an electric motion platform and a customizable instrument deck for realistic training.

Air Traffic Control Lab

Green River Aviation houses the only air traffic control lab in the Pacific Northwest. Advanced computer software simulates real-life air traffic so students gain exposure to the air traffic environment in the classroom.

Wind Tunnel
Learn the aerodynamics of aircrafting right on campus with a wind tunnel that simulates the movement of air around an aircraft in flight.

Interested in learning more?
Please contact George Comollo 253-931-6577, or via email at GComollo@greenriver.edu

Follow us on Facebook at: Green River College Aviation

On Instagram at grcaviation

Or visit our website: www.greenriver.edu/aviation